

AI-Assisted Work: Community Edition

What This Is

This is a practical framework for anyone using AI tools to run projects, build products, or manage documentation in their business.

It answers one question: how do I stop AI-assisted work from becoming an unmanageable mess?

The framework does not require a technical background. It does not assume knowledge of software development, procurement, or governance theory. It is designed for business owners, operators, consultants, and anyone who works alongside AI tools and wants their work to stay organised, traceable, and under control.

Who This Is For

- Business owners using AI tools to create documents, plans, or systems
 - Consultants managing client work with AI assistance
 - Small teams adopting AI tools for the first time
 - Anyone who has experienced AI-assisted work growing chaotic over time
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Why These Documents Are in Markdown (.md)

Every document here is a **Markdown** (.md) file — plain text with a few simple formatting marks (you write ****bold**** and it shows as **bold**). We use it because it is future-proof, opens in almost any tool, works everywhere AI tools and version control do, and makes changes easy to track — none of which is true of a Word file locked in one app's format.

If .md files are new to you — including how to open one and how to format text — start with [Working with Markdown \(.md\) Files](#). It covers the essential formatting and the (mostly free) tools for both Mac and Windows.

What Is Included

Guides

Document	Purpose
How to Work with AI Without Losing Control	The starting point. Read this first.
AI Collaboration and Governance Framework	How to structure roles between humans and AI tools.
Project File Structure	How to organise your project’s files — on GitHub, a cloud drive, or your own computer.
Working with Markdown (.md) Files	What .md files are, essential formatting, and the (mostly free) tools to open and edit them.
AI Requirements and Taxonomy Guide	How to classify and track requirements in AI-assisted projects.
YAML Front Matter and Metadata Standard	How to add lightweight metadata to Markdown documents.

Templates

Template	Purpose
Master BRD Template	Document the overall scope and objectives of a project or product.
Module BRD Template	Document one bounded capability or component of a larger project.
FRD Template	Functional and non-functional requirements for a small or single-capability project (paired with a Master BRD or brief).
Requirement Template	Capture a single requirement in a structured, traceable format.
Technical Design Document Template	Describe how the solution will be built to meet the requirements.
Decision Record Template	Record a material decision so it can be understood later.
Issues Register Template	Track unresolved questions, concerns, and non-blocking issues.
Handover Template	Hand work from one party to another — build to operation, between contributors, or at project close.

Getting Started

You do not need to read everything first. The shortest path to value:

1. **Read [How to Work with AI Without Losing Control](#)**. Plain language, about ten minutes, explains the *why*.
2. **Create a home for your project** — a single folder, on your computer, a cloud drive, or GitHub. [Project File Structure](#) gives you a layout to copy.
3. **Pick your document set** — small project or large? See “Choosing Your Document Set” below, then copy the templates you need into your folder.
4. **Fill them in as you go**. Leave sections blank where they don’t apply yet. The templates are starting points, not forms to finish in one sitting.
5. **Keep two habits from day one**: record material decisions (Decision Record), and write down open questions instead of trusting you’ll remember them (Issues Register).

That is enough to start. Come back to the other guides when you want the deeper explanation. New to any of the terms below? See [Key Terms](#).

Choosing Your Document Set

Scale the documents to the size of the project. You do not need every template — pick the set that matches the work.

Small or single-capability project

- **Master BRD** (used lightly) or a short project brief — the business context.
- **FRD** — the functional *and* non-functional requirements in one document.
- **Technical Design Document** — how it will be built.

Large or multi-capability project

- **Master BRD** — scope, objectives, principles, and system-wide (“cross-cutting”) requirements.
- **Module BRD** per capability — each carries that capability’s business, functional, and non-functional requirements.
- **Technical Design Document(s)** — how it will be built.

Across both: use the **Requirement Template** to expand any single requirement that needs depth; keep a **Decision Record** and **Issues Register** running; and produce a **Handover** when work passes to someone else or the project closes.

[!NOTE]

Where do non-functional requirements go? *They always travel with the requirements layer — never left floating. In a small project they sit in the FRD’s Non-Functional Requirements section. In a large project, system-wide NFRs go in the Master BRD’s Cross-Cutting Requirements and capability-specific NFRs go in each Module BRD.*

Suggested Reading Order

1. How to Work with AI Without Losing Control
2. AI Collaboration and Governance Framework
3. Project File Structure
4. Working with Markdown (.md) Files
5. AI Requirements and Taxonomy Guide
6. YAML Front Matter and Metadata Standard
7. Templates: as needed

If you are short on time, read document 1 and go straight to the templates. Return to documents 2, 3, and 4 when you need deeper explanation.

How to Use the Templates

Each template is a starting point, not a rigid form. Copy the template, fill in what is relevant, and leave sections blank where they do not apply yet.

The templates include YAML front matter at the top. This is explained in the YAML guide. At minimum, fill in title, status, version, and owner before sharing any document.

How to Adapt This Framework

The framework is intentionally general. You do not need every template or every practice to benefit from it. Start with what solves your immediate problem and add structure as your projects grow.

Four principles that should not be skipped regardless of how lightly you adopt this framework:

- Keep a record of material decisions.
 - Track unresolved issues rather than assuming they will resolve themselves.
 - Ensure one human is accountable for every output.
 - Do not let AI tools resolve material uncertainty without your explicit direction.
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Key Terms

Plain-language definitions of the terms used across this bundle.

Term	What it means
BRD — Business Requirements Document	What the project needs to achieve and why, from a business point of view.
FRD — Functional Requirements Document	The detailed list of what the system must <i>do</i> , plus how well it must do it. Used for smaller projects.
Module	One bounded part of a larger project — a single capability documented and built on its own.
TDD — Technical Design Document	<i>How</i> the solution will be built to meet the requirements.
NFR — Non-Functional Requirement	How <i>well</i> the system must perform — speed, reliability, security, ease of use — as opposed to what it does.
Decision Record	A short note capturing a material choice and the reasoning, so it can be understood later.
Issues Register	A running list of open questions and unresolved concerns.
Handover	A document that lets someone else take over the work without the context in your head.
RACI	A simple way to show, for each task, who is R esponsible, A ccountable, C onsulted, and I nformed.
Repository (repo)	A project's folder of files. On GitHub it also keeps a history of every change.
Markdown (.md)	Plain text with light formatting (headings, lists, tables). These documents are all Markdown — readable in any text editor.
YAML front matter	The small block of labels at the very top of each document (title, status, version). Explained in the YAML guide.

Version History

Version	Date	Author	Summary
0.1	2026-05-28		Initial draft
0.2	2026-06-09	Claude Code	Added FRD, Technical Design Document, and Handover templates; added “Choosing Your Document Set” guidance (two tiers + where NFRs live)
0.3	2026-06-09	Claude Code	Added Project File Structure guide; expanded README for non-technical readers (Getting Started steps, Key Terms glossary)
0.4	2026-06-09	Claude Code	Added Working with Markdown (.md) Files guide and a “Why Markdown” section to the README
1.0	2026-06-13	Jason Masters	Initial Version (Approved)